MECH-DOOMER: REBOOTED

MANUAL

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1) PREFACE

1a) Introduction

First and foremost, I must emphasize the importance of **visiting the "Mod Options" menu and setting up your key binds!**

This mod will not function correctly at all unless you have all the required key binds set up: these are indicated by brackets "[]" proceeding a control, the key inside the brackets is the suggested default key bind, if you are having trouble deciding yourself. **You will also need the latest version of UZDoom to run MechDoomer: Rebooted.**

In this Manual we will go over the core systems every pilot needs to know; how to drive your mech, how to customize it into the perfect war machine and how to repair any damage your mech might suffer along the way. Let's first start with some general information about this mod, MechDoomer: Rebooted is a mech simulator experience taking place in a universe where BattleTech meets Doom, because of this it is important to have a basic understanding about how some BattleTech systems work, as you'll need to make heavy use of this knowledge in-order to use your mechs effectively. As far as compatibility goes, this mod will work with most of your favorite gameplay mods, as mechs serve as vehicles which you can enter and exit whenever you want. So, yes, it's even compatible with Brutal Doom! Funnily enough. However, the dropship map makes use of Doom 2 textures, and due to this the mod is not compatible with either Hexen or Heretic. One somewhat important quirk of this mod has to do with cluster text, or the paragraph summary which typically displays after the end of any episode; this mod disables that feature. The reason for this has to do with the dropship hub, which you enter after the end of each map. The dropship hub exists outside of any cluster, so to avoid having to click through the same message every time you finish a map, hence it has been disabled.

2) PILOTING YOUR MECH

2a) Basic Controls

By default, mechs are controlled by an eight-directional movement system; pressing strafe left or strafe right will turn a mech's legs towards the left or right direction based on how fast the turn rate of the mech is. If you combine left or right movement keys with either forward or back, this will allow you to walk diagonally in the desired direction, and when reversing your mech will move at half its maximum speed. Aiming with the mouse will first move your mechs arms, this is indicated by the two small circles next to your crosshair, your mech's torso will then follow where your arms are aiming towards based on how fast the mech can turn itself. It's important to note the distinction between leg turn speed and torso turn speed; a mech's leg turn speed will determine how quickly you can change your movement direction, and its torso turn speed will determine how quickly you can change your aiming direction. However, you can fire your weapons before your torso catches up, this will result in any arm mounted weapons firing towards where your arms (smaller circles) are currently aiming, and any torso mounted weapons firing wherever your torso (bigger crosshair) is currently facing.

2b) Tank Controls

Alternatively, tank controls can be enabled under the "Mod Options" menu. While using tank controls, you'll have more granular control over your mechs movement direction; when you press the left or right movement keys, your mechs legs will turn to the left or right respectively. The forward and back keys will either increase or decrease your throttle speed, and by pressing the "Set Throttle to 0" key, you can stop your movement. You can also enable "Throttle Decay" which will automatically move your throttle to zero when the forward and back keys are not being pressed.

3) DROPSHIP

3a) Introduction

At the end of each map, you will be brought to your personal dropship, this serves as kind of HUB map where you can repair and rearm your mechs, shop for new mechs and items, sell items and mechs you no longer need, and organize your mech bays. By default, when you begin a playthrough you will be brought to your dropship before the first map starts, this can be disabled under the “Mod Options” menu in which case you will start the first map with the Commando - 7X’s default loadout. The Commando is a lightly armored mech all new playthroughs begin with, while this is a very capable mech you will soon find that to complete more challenging maps, you will need something with both more firepower and armor.

3b) Marketplace

As you progress, you’ll gain money in the form of “C-Bills”, denoted by the ₵ icon in the upper left corner of your HUD. To spend these C-Bills you will need to head over to the marketplace, located towards the back of your dropship. The marketplace menu is opened by interacting with the computer. Here you will find all sorts of items available for purchase; weapons, ammunition, engines, utility items and mechs. It’s important to note that you cannot buy and sell items at the same time, if you drag items from your inventory (left-hand

side) into the middle box, this will put the marketplace into sell mode, and if you drag items from the market (right-hand side) into the middle box, this will enable buy mode. You can also search for items by name using the search field located above either the left box or right box.

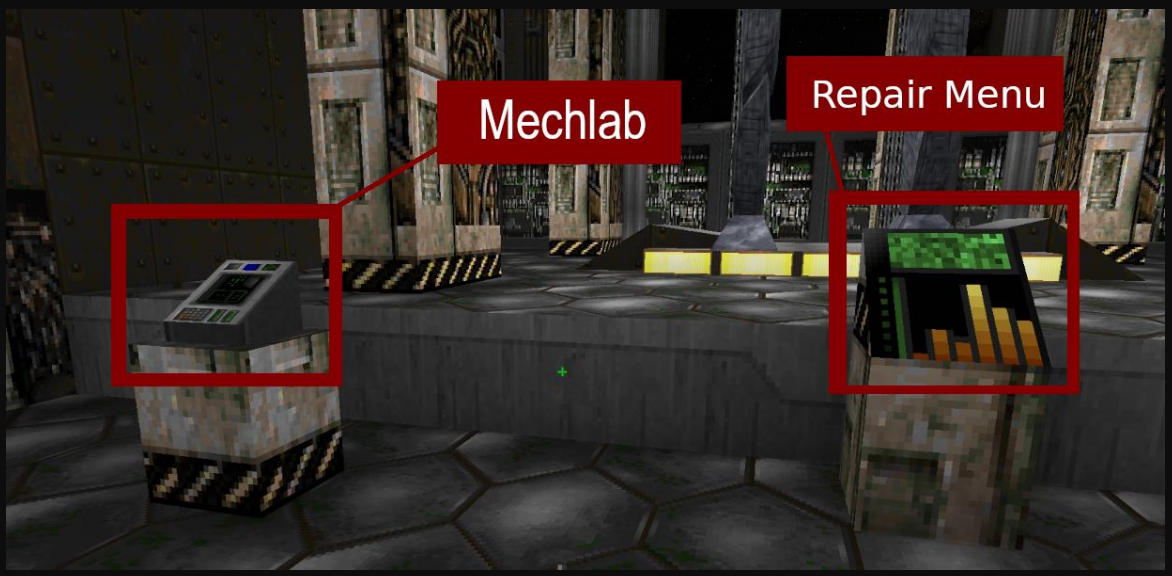
3c) Mech Bays

When you purchase a mech, it will typically appear in your dropship next to one of your other mechs, however the dropship has a maximum of 10 bays available to store mechs in. If you have more than 10 mechs, you will need to head to the “Mech Storage” computer to change which mechs are currently active. In this menu, mechs are represented by cards which can be moved from or to your active pool (left-hand side) into or out of your passive pool (right-hand side) by dragging and dropping a mech card from or to either location. Mechs can also be sorted by tonnage, via the drop-down box located below the search field. Note: the search field can also be used to sort mechs by engine type.

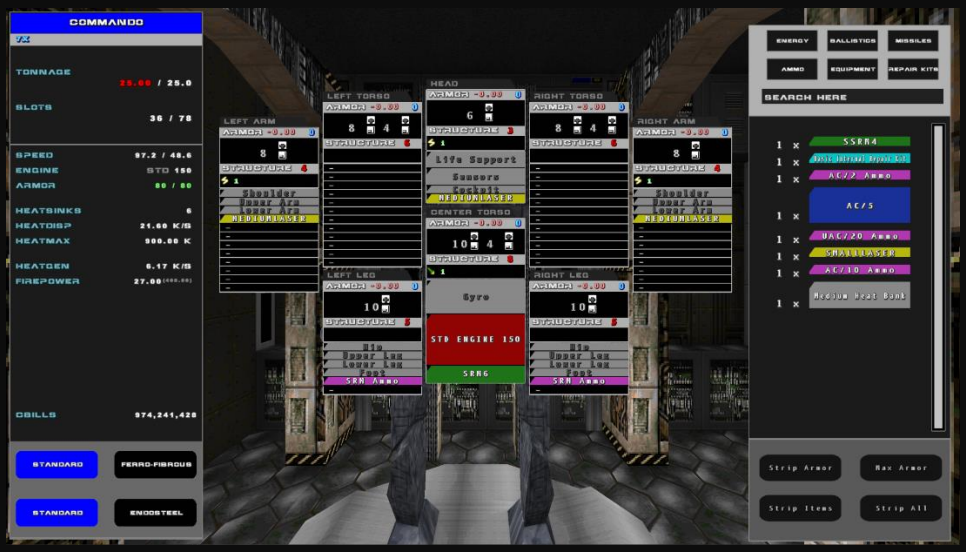
3d) Leaving the Dropship

When you are finished using the services available in the dropship, to proceed to the next map you can interact with the exit door located at the front of your dropship, this will play a short animation of the dropship landing sequence (which can be skipped by pressing the Use key) followed by transitioning you into the next map.

4) EQUIPMENT

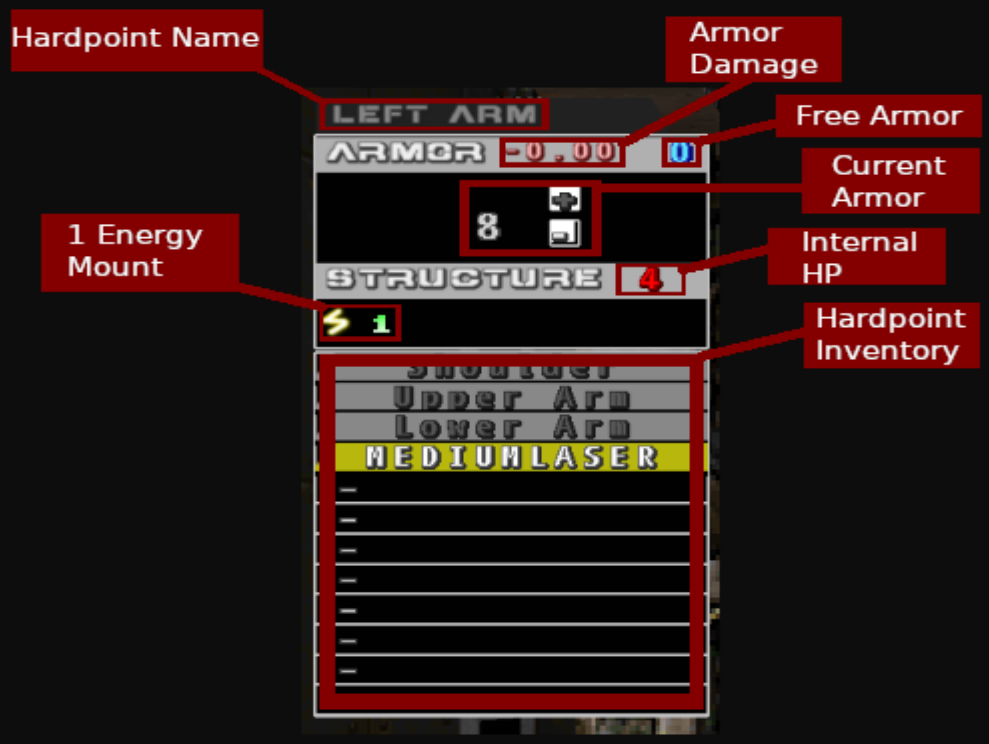


4a) Mechlab



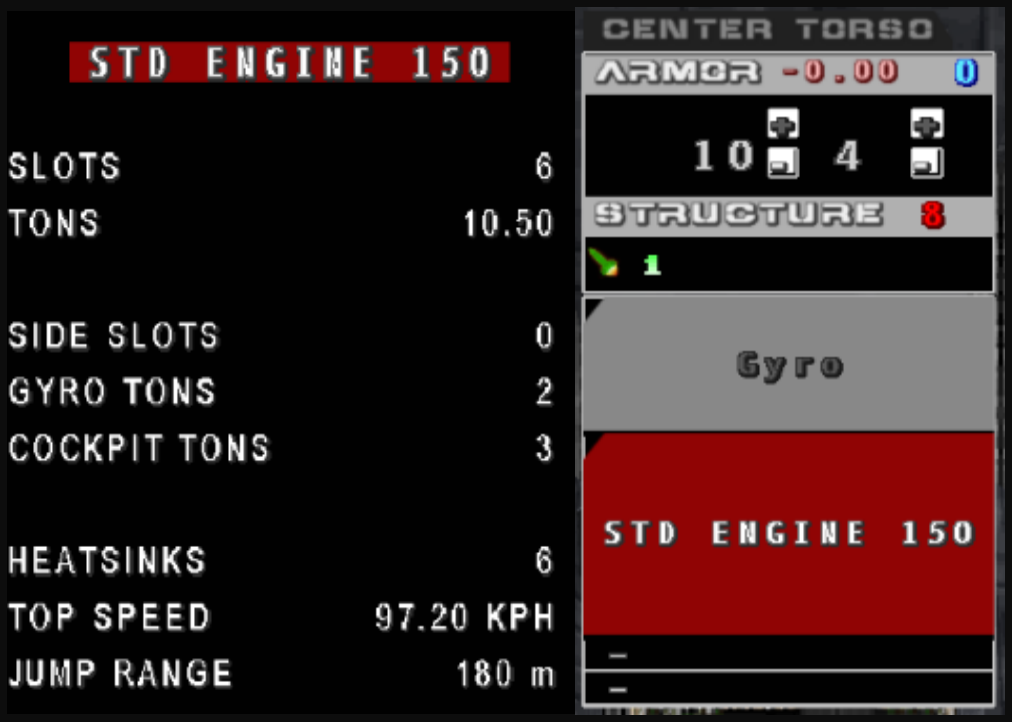
The mechlab is accessed by interacting with the corresponding mechlab computer located in front of each mech bay. This is where you will customize your mechs internals, allocate armor points, equip weapons, ammo and other items. Each item can be dragged and dropped from your inventory on the right, into your mechs hardpoints, or vice versa.

4b) Hardpoints



In the center of the mechlab you will find your mechs hardpoints, these are storage regions on your mech which house critical structural components as well as weapons and other items. At the top of each hardpoint is a unique name assigned to it, for example “Left Arm” and “Right Arm” are the inventories of your mechs left and right arms. Hardpoints also have unique health and armor pools. Different items will have different sizes and thus take up varying amounts of space when equipped to a corresponding hardpoint. For example, the medium laser takes 1 slot, as shown above. However, some weapons such as the Large Laser will require 2 slots of inventory space. You’ll find that some of the most powerful weapons such as the Gauss Rifle can take up a hardpoints entire inventory space. The gray items are critical structures which allow a hardpoint to function physically, these cannot be moved or modified. In addition to taking up slots, items also have weight to them, which must also be considered, as each mech has a maximum weight it can carry.

4c) Engines



Every mech must have an engine equipped in-order to power itself (Engines can only be equipped in a mechs “Center Torso” hardpoint). These engines come in many different form-factors and ratings: STD or Standard engines are the heaviest variety of engine types; however, they also take up the least amount of space. XL or Extra-Light engines are much lighter than standard engines, however they also occupy some space in the mechs left and right torsos. XXL engines are the lightest variety of engines, which occupy a significant amount of space in mechs side torsos and are by far the most expensive variety of engine types. Depending on which engine you decide to go with, this will determine how fast your mech can move, as well as how high it can propel itself by using Jump Jets. You can observe an engines stats by hovering over it, this will tell you how fast your mech would move if it were equipped, and how high it would be able to jump. Engines also come pre-loaded with heatsinks, the more of these items your mech has equipped, the faster it is able to dissipate the heat generated from its weapons.

4d) Mount Types

Some hardpoints have specific mounting points designed into their internal structure, depending on the type present this will indicate which kind of weapons can be equipped onto a particular hardpoint. Certain weapons will also drain energy from a mech's engine, as indicated by the battery indicator icon ( ) displayed on your mechs HUD. There are four different kinds of mount types:

I) Energy

Energy mounts are denoted by the icon, hardpoints with this icon can equip energy weapons. Some energy weapons will consume a large amount of your reactor's energy, these can bottleneck other weapons when fired, preventing your mech from firing off multiple weapons at once.

II) Missile

Missile mounts are denoted by the icon, hardpoints with this icon can equip missile weapons. Some missile weapons have homing capabilities, which will require a target lock to use, in-order to lock onto a target, you must place your aiming reticle on a given target and keep it there until your mech has locked onto it.

III) Ballistic

Ballistic mounts are denoted by the icon, hardpoints with this icon can equip ballistic weapons. Certain ballistic weapons such as the Ultra Autocannons can occasionally jam, when this occurs, you will have to wait until they unjam before you can fire them again.

IV) Pod

Pod mounts or alternatively "PDS", are denoted by the icon, these items generally include autonomous weaponry such as Anti-Missile-Systems.

4e) Ammunition

Some weapons will require ammunition in-order to fire, most commonly ballistic or missile weapons will require supplemental ammunition equipped somewhere else on the mech. (Note: it doesn't matter where ammunition is equipped, it does not have to be in the same hardpoint as the weapon for example). Some weapons can accept multiple different types of ammunition, depending on which is loaded, a weapons behavior will change. The ATM missile, for example, can use 3 different types of ammunition, standard ammunition which fires a dumb-fire missile, extended range which will increase their maximum range, and high-explosive which will eliminate their minimum range at the cost of a reduced maximum range. You do need to be somewhat mindful of where you place ammunition, however, as if your mech takes damage to its internals there is a chance that the ammunition equipped can explode and damage the surrounding hardpoints. For this reason, many pilots prefer to equip ammunition in their mechs legs, as this keeps any potential explosion away from more critical hardpoints such as the side or center torso(s).

4f) Support Items

Some items can be used to support others, for example the C.A.S.E item will contain internal explosions, such as those caused by ammo, to the hardpoint in which it is equipped preventing the spread of explosive damage to adjacent hardpoints. Heatsinks can also be equipped wherever there is inventory space and are used to hasten a mechs ability to dissipate heat. Items such as M.A.S.C can aid a mechs mobility for a limited time, allowing a mech to run faster and make tighter turns. It is also worth picking up some repair kits from the marketplace, as these can be used outside of the dropship to repair damaged regions of your mech, and even fix destroyed items.

5) ARMOR AND CHASSIS

5a) Armor Types

Most mechs will come pre-equipped with a standard armor structure, which weighs 0.05 tons per armor point equipped on the mech. Armor points can be modified by pressing the buttons in the mechlab. The plus button will increase the armor points allocated, and the minus button will decrease it. Mechs have a maximum amount of armor which can be equipped to a given hardpoint, and the armor points available are indicated by the blue number located on the upper-right corner of a hardpoints. Some hardpoints such as the left/right and center torsos, also have rear armor which uses the same armor pool but must be equipped separately. When a mech takes damage, it will first accumulate armor damage, and once its armor points run out, it will begin to take internal damage. To free up weight, beyond just decreasing the amount of armor on your mech, you can also purchase the Ferro-Fibrous armor structure, this will decrease the weight of each armor point from 0.05 tons down to 0.04 tons, which can add up when your mech has a few dozen armor points equipped. Ferro armor does come at a cost though, as it will consume additional slots all around your mech called “Armor Structure” slots (or “criticals”). These slots are special in that they can dynamically move around the mech, however when there is no more free space for them to move to, they become locked and will prevent additional items from being equipped.

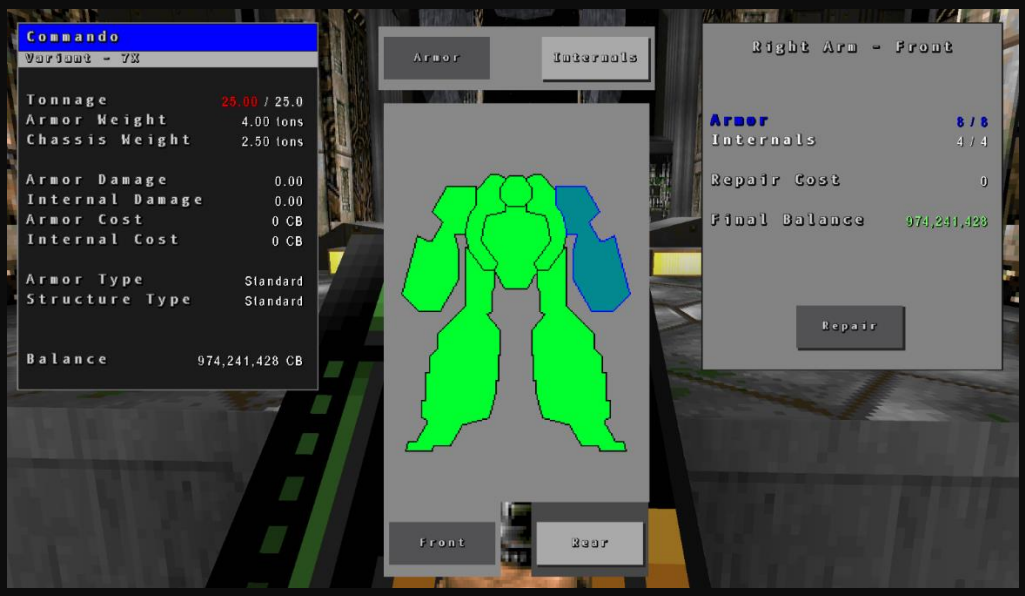
5b) Chassis Types

A mech's internal structural type can also be modified, by default mechs come with a Standard internal structure, which has a weight equal to one tenth of the mechs maximum tonnage. If you find yourself running up your mechs tonnage, it can be useful to purchase the Endosteel internal structure which will reduce a mechs internal weight by 50% at the cost of taking up additional "Structure" slots, which like the aforementioned "Armor Structure" more around dynamically as adjacent slots are filled, until there is no more room available for them to move to. It is worth noting that both Ferro and Endo can be stacked for maximum weight saving, at the cost of significant inventory space reduction.

5c) Advanced Structures

Some mechs come equipped with advanced structures, which cannot be modified. Examples include the "Timberwolf" mech, which comes with both Ferro and Endo, at the benefit of half the slot space occupied by both.

5d) Repairing Damage

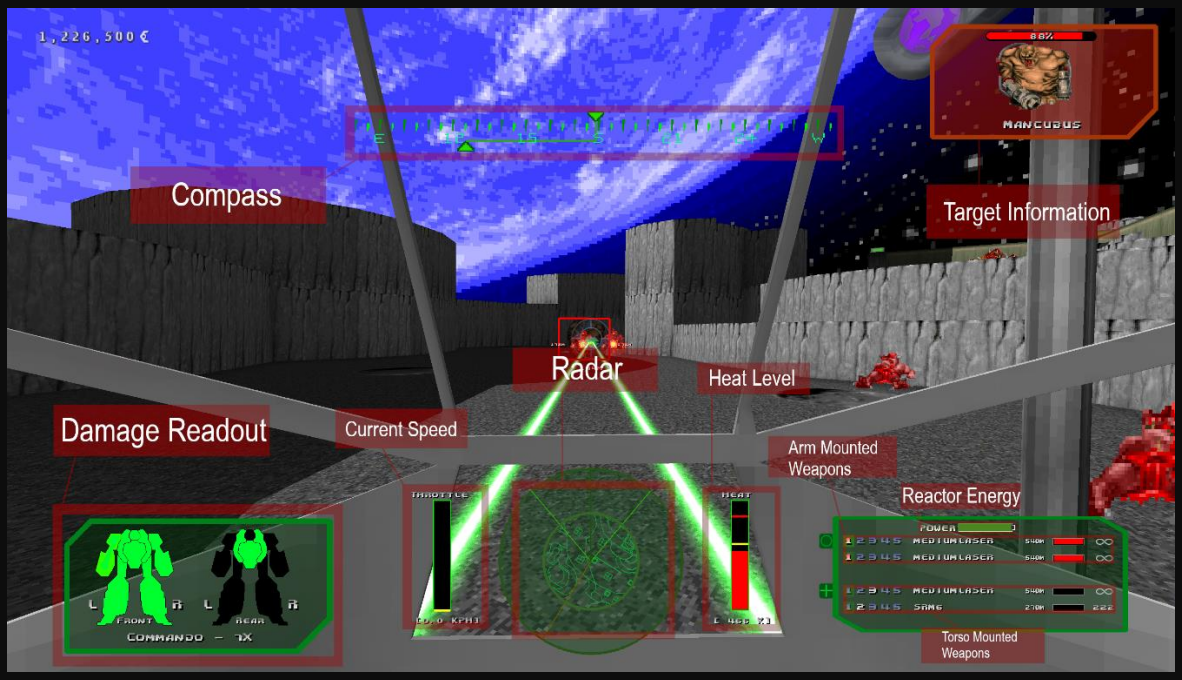


Damage can be repaired by interacting with the Repair computer, adjacent to the mechlab. Here you can select damaged hardpoints to repair, you will need

to switch between the “Internals” and “Armor” tab to see different categories of damage. The left-hand panel displays the current armor and internal structure types as well as the overall C-Bill cost to repair your mech. Some hardpoints such as the left and right arms, if destroyed, cannot be repaired unless the left and right torsos are first repaired to a functional state. The cost of repairs also depends on the structure type you are using, Endosteel and Ferro-Fibrous are significantly more expensive to repair compared to standard structure types.

6) COMBAT

6a) Hud Overview



I) Weapon Groups

On the lower right-hand side of your HUD, you will find an array of numbers: 1 2 3 4 5 respectively, these are your weapon groups. In-order to fire a weapon it must first be placed in at least one of these groups, this can be done by pressing the next/previous group key binds followed by pressing the toggle group key, likewise specific weapons can be selected by pressing the next/previous weapon key. After a weapon has been assigned to a group, it can

then be fired by pressing the corresponding “Fire Group #” key. Pressing this key will also fire all weapons assigned to a given group at the same time.

II) Fire Modes

Alternatively, by pressing the “Toggle Chainfire” key, this will enable sequential fire for a given group, weapons assigned to this group will then fire one after another. You can also press the fire button multiple times to speed up the sequential firing process.

III) Heat Management

Most weapons will generate heat when fired, if enough heat is accumulated your mech will prompt an emergency shutdown to avoid internal heat damage, this process can be overridden by pressing the “Override Shutdown” key, however you must pay close attention to your heat level, as going over the red bar on your HUD will result in your mech taking internal heat damage, and if you’re especially unlucky this can damage weapons or items in your mech, sometimes causing ammo to overheat and explode as well. The more heatsinks your mech has equipped, the more heat it can store before overheating, additionally your mech will also cool down faster. You can also equip heat banks which temporarily store heat and dissipate it on their own.

6b) Switchable Weapons

Some weapons such as the PPC can be interacted with if selected. Pressing the “Weapon State” button with a weapon selected will change its state, if supported. For example, if the weapon state button is pressed with a PPC selected, this will prompt the weapon to disable it’s Field Inhibitor, getting rid of its minimum range requirements, at the cost of dealing damage and messing with your mechs sensors when fired at close range. This button can also be used on ATMs to switch their ammo type, if that type of ammo is equipped on your mech.

6c) Repair Drone

If your mech has some superficial armor damage, it can be shutdown and repaired for free via the use of the Repair Drone. The drone will work for as long as there is repairable damage present on your mech, and you're holding down the "Repair Drone" key. Note: the repair drone cannot repair internal damage, only superficial damage to your mechs armor, if your mech has more critical armor damage, the repair drone will also be unable to address this, for example in the image above, the repair drone is unable to address the damage done to the Commando's left leg.

6d) Field Mechlab

The mechlab can be accessed outside of the dropship provided your mech is first shutdown. The field mechlab is also significantly more limited compared to its dropship counterpart; suppose you run out of ammo for one of your weapons, you can then open the field mechlab and swap out spent ammunition, however you cannot change the weapons you currently have equipped. Additionally, if you have repair kits in your inventory, you can use them here as well.

6e) Salvage

After finishing a map, you may have recovered salvage carried by some of the enemies you have defeated. You can take as many items as you have available tonnage for. Your dropship can carry 25 tons, and your mech around 20% of its maximum weight plus any additional free tonnage you may have left available. Salvage items come in varying conditions, Pristine being the highest quality drops you can get. You can also get ammunition with varying amounts of ammo stored inside of it. For example, the Gauss Ammo in the image above contains no ammo loaded, and is essentially just gauss ammo casing, this also affects its worth as ammunition sells for more depending on how full it is. The V/W stat represents the Weight per C-Bill value of an item, so for example some lighter item might be worth less than the Standard Engine selected here, however if there is more of them, it might be a better idea to take those instead of the engine, if you’re looking to maximize your C-Bill profit.